Sleep is precious, and time is precious as well. My schedule tends to be so busy that there is just no time to do everything I would like to do, and I worry that people can feel either let down or brushed off because I don't get around to seeing them or contacting them. There are just not enough hours in the day.

This is a typical scenario: I will meet somebody and we will discuss a project. I will be genuinely enthusiastic and, as ever, eager to please; we will start making plans. Weeks go by. Nothing happens because I have no time to make anything happen, and people may start to think I've lost interest or I no longer care and, on a few occasions, I have probably been guilty of creating unrealistic expectations.

It bothers me a lot. I remember Graeme Smith once telling me that the key to surviving the life of a busy professional sports person is simply to say no. You can't keep everyone happy, he would say, so sometimes you have to say no, you can't attend that event, you can't get involved in that venture. Rather like the character played by Jim Carrey in *Yes Man*, the 2008 film, I too often find it much easier to say yes.

To be honest, whenever the relentless schedule does allow me some free time to myself, I far prefer to spend that time with my family, ideally lying on a bed beside my young son, watching him sleep, quietly wondering what the future holds for him, casually pondering what kind of man he will grow up to be.

He will be exactly what he will be, of course, and I will be completely content to see him develop as he wants but, from what I have learned over the years, most youngsters benefit from being active, from having a fighting spirit, from being able to have fun and from enjoying music.

Being active means getting out and about, participating in organised sport or any kind of exercise, being the kind of person who would sign up to run a half-marathon just for fun. I competed in the Knysna half-marathon a couple of times, first in 2011 with Mark Boucher, Jacques Kallis and Rob Walter, a good friend who was then a conditioning coach